disavow any link between the terrorist entities and individuals inside Pakistan from its government and official agencies; (c) maintain stability in the India–China relationship; and (d) leverage the issue for securing India's cooperation on China's own concerns about 'splittist' forces in Tibet and Xinjiang. China's position was difficult. The Indian proposal to the Sanctions Committee had the potential to de-stabilize the balance that China had carefully crafted in its own relations with both India and Pakistan. Taking sides threatened to undo the work of many years. Pakistan's dependence on China alone to help its cause became an added pressure point because China did not want to be seen as 'defending' or 'justifying' terrorism. The growing divide between China and America complicated the matter still further, because China's actions might push India closer to the Americans. Suspicions about American intentions towards China had escalated after President Xi Jinping took office, and China did not wish India to get off the fence. China's negotiating strategy was crafted around its objectives with a view to skirting all these potential pitfalls.

China resorted to delaying consideration of the Indian request in the 1267 Committee on procedural grounds. Under the rules of procedure, any committee member is entitled to keep the 'hold' in place for up to nine months. By placing a hold, China bought itself some time. In discussions with India, the Chinese claimed that the criteria for listing had to be based on solid evidence, and that the material supplied by the Indian side needed more discussion. In this manner, China was also able to stave off matters coming to a head inside the committee by claiming that they were engaging with India.

They also resorted to a further procedural loophole, which stipulates, 'Before a Member State proposes a name for inclusion on the ISIS (Daesh) or Al-Qaida Sanctions List, it is requested to the extent possible, to approach the State(s) of